PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, January 20, 2026

Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center , 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members:
Director Virginia LaForte (Committee Chair); Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; and Director Rashelle Chase-Miller

Attendees:
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant; Board Clerk
Jennifer Eggers – Principal Engineer, Holmes
Joanna Evenson – Director, Project Management & Construction
Dr. Jon Franco – Senior Chief of Operations
Janise Hansen – Senior Internal Auditor
TJ Hopkins – Sr. Director, Bond Program
Liz Large – Contracted Senior Legal Advisor
Sarah Norman – Executive Director for PPS, Procedeo
Tom Odgers – Chief of Integrated Operations
Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education

Call to Order / Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:32 pm by Committee Chair Virginia La Forte. Attendees introduced themselves.

Public Comment

Time: 4:34 pm

- Lila Almeida – Urged the district to complete the Lincoln baseball fields as soon as possible due to their impact on students and athletic programs.
- C.J. Watson – Urged the district to complete the Lincoln baseball fields as soon as possible due to their impact on students and athletic programs.
- Kim Worsham – Requested the Committee prioritize the expedited completion of athletic fields.
- Afton Wilcox – Requested transparency in seismic project prioritization and planning decisions.
- Nicole Kemper – Urged the district not to delay athletic facility projects.

Bond Audit Recommendations

Time: 4:50 pm

Staff: Janis Hansen and Dr. Jon Franco

Staff provided an overview of the Bond Accountability Committee Charter, including its oversight and accountability role and proposed areas for updating the charter. The presentation highlighted the auditor recommendations related to transparency and governance, including documentation practices, clarity of

responsibilities, committee composition, and meeting frequency. It was noted that the recommendations were intended to initiate discussion.

Board members asked questions and provided comments, with discussion focused on the scope of bond audits, the role of the contract manager, and the appropriate process for revising the charter. Feedback emphasized that revisions should be staff-led, reviewed by the BAC committee, and approved by the full Board, with interest in balancing clarity and simplicity and aligning the charter with voter intent. Staff will draft proposed revisions based on committee feedback and bring them back for further review.

Office of School Modernization Updates:

Time: 5:43 pm

Sarah Norman, Jennifer Eggers, TJ Hopkins

Staff provided updates across several bond-related topics, including progress on bond audit recommendations, the status of seismic grants and upgrades, Portland Clean Energy Fund initiatives, the 2025 bond procurement schedule, and major athletic projects. The update noted that seismic projects are in the design phase, with a mix of comprehensive and targeted retrofits, and that grant funding is being pursued to support the comprehensive projects. Staff also reported progress with Portland Clean Energy Fund awards, including preparatory work, compliance with grant requirements, coordination with partners, and advancement of both building upgrades and student-led projects.

Staff outlined the 2025 bond procurement approach, highlighting the use of phased and pooled procurements to support efficiency and timely delivery across projects. An overview of major athletic projects was provided, noting that projects are generally in early design and permitting stages, with timelines dependent on regulatory approvals and contractor selection. Board members asked questions and provided comments related to project prioritization, site selection, procurement strategies, and the overall timeline and status of athletic and capital projects.

Other Business and Future Agenda Topics

6:19 pm

No requests for future agenda topics were shared. Committee Chair La Forte requested that Board Members share any topics that come up with Rosanne Powell.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 6:19 pm

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools